VOLTA-AUTODOXER

Campaign-specific endpoint artifact hunt

THREAT DOSSIER

Self-deleting infostealer with AI victim appraisal

Microsoft Defender XDR | Hunting | Confidence Medium

Operational Value 8/10

Classification: Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch

Logic: Campaign-specific artifact

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Executive Assessment

Decision-grade summary

DECISION

Publish a scoped exposure hunt for the exact executable SHA-256 and the source-published %APPDATA%\volta_debug.txt harvest log. Do not alert on chrome.exe --headless alone: legitimate automation overlap is high.

SOURCE FACTS

Talos analyzed a self-named VOLTA-AUTODOXER sample. It steals browser credentials, cookies, tokens, wallets, SSH/cloud keys and Wi-Fi profiles; builds Identity_Report.txt; calls OpenRouter; receives AI_Analysis.txt; stages ZIP archives; and can delete itself.

LIMITS

Talos reports sample first seen on 11 October 2026 but does not establish a confirmed victim campaign or actor-owned infrastructure. Artifact presence is an investigative lead, not proof of collection, exfiltration or monetization.

Threat Mechanics

Observed code behavior and evidence

COLLECTION

Browser passwords, cookies, payment cards, OAuth tokens, SSH/cloud keys, Wi-Fi profiles, screenshots and application sessions.

ENRICHMENT

Stolen sessions query Gmail receipts, delivery history, Discord and Roblox data to corroborate identity and value.

AI APPRAISAL

A structured evidence bundle is POSTed to OpenRouter; a three-model fallback chain ranks monetizable assets and OPSEC.

STAGING

Identity_Report.txt and AI_Analysis.txt are packaged with collected material into volta_dox.zip; other ZIP stages are also described.

CLEANUP

The executable is self-deleting; volta_debug.txt may preserve timestamps and collection/LLM outcomes.

Telemetry & Evidence Model

Required fields and observability

REQUIRED TELEMETRY

Microsoft Defender for Endpoint DeviceFileEvents covering Windows endpoints and the relevant 30-day hunting horizon.

DOCUMENTED FIELDS

Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, ActionType, FolderPath, FileName, SHA256, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessAccountName and ReportId.

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT

DeviceProcessEvents for chrome.exe --headless, archive creation, executable lineage and self-deletion; browser extension/session context; identity and cloud session revocation evidence.

UNAVAILABLE FROM QUERY

File contents, successful credential extraction, model response, ZIP exfiltration, Telegram delivery, victim impact and attribution.

Primary Hunting Logic

Microsoft Defender XDR KQL

```
DeviceFileEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(30d)
| where SHA256 =~ "57ef4242666d78c50df145b34023df564f0fad38812d6a580e66433d427e2279"
   or (FileName =~ "volta_debug.txt" and FolderPath contains @"\AppData\Roaming\")
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, ActionType, FolderPath, FileName,
          SHA256, InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
          InitiatingProcessAccountName, ReportId
| order by Timestamp desc
```

EVIDENCE PER CONDITION

The SHA-256 and volta_debug.txt path are directly published by Talos. SHA256 may be unpopulated in DeviceFileEvents, so the exact debug-file path provides a separate hunting lead. No rarity, count or arbitrary threshold is used.

STATUS

Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch. Campaign-specific and mutable; not a durable Production candidate.

Triage & Investigation

Evidence-led disposition

1. PRESERVE

Collect the binary, volta_debug.txt, Identity_Report.txt, AI_Analysis.txt and ZIP artifacts before cleanup.

2. VALIDATE HASH AND PATH

Confirm exact SHA-256, full path, creation time, creator process and user context.

3. RECONSTRUCT EXECUTION

Review parent/child process lineage, browser --headless execution, credential-store access and archive creation.

4. SCOPE SESSIONS

Revoke browser, Microsoft, Discord, Telegram, Steam, SSH, cloud-provider and wallet access as supported by evidence.

5. DISPOSITION

Escalate only when artifact provenance or adjacent behavior supports VOLTA execution; filename alone remains insufficient.

False Positives & Validation

Promotion gates and failure conditions

BENIGN OVERLAP

The SHA-256 is high specificity. volta_debug.txt could be recreated by researchers or unrelated software. chrome.exe --headless is common in testing, monitoring and automation and is enrichment only.

VALIDATION STEPS

1) Create a controlled file under %APPDATA% and verify path representation. 2) Measure SHA256 population. 3) Verify creator-process context. 4) Measure filename prevalence and inspect content/provenance for every match.

SUCCESS

Controlled artifacts appear with exact device, path, hash and initiating process; true matches are attributable to the analyzed sample or controlled testing.

REJECTION / FAILURE

Reject alert promotion if filename collisions cannot be separated. Telemetry validation fails if controlled writes are absent or required context is systematically empty.

ATT&CK, Conclusion & References

Coverage statement and document control

ATT&CK

T1555 Credentials from Password Stores; T1539 Steal Web Session Cookie; T1552.001 Credentials In Files; T1074.001 Local Data Staging. These are supported by Talos code-analysis facts, not inferred victim impact.

CONCLUSION

VOLTA is technically interesting because the LLM performs post-theft prioritization, but defenders should detect the endpoint collection and staging artifacts. This package is a rapid, campaign-specific hunt with Medium confidence and must remain untested until executed in the target tenant.

REFERENCES

Cisco Talos, 31 Oct 2026: hxxps://blog[.]talosintelligence[.]com/appraisal-by-ai-model-driven-victim-prioritization-in-the-volta-infostealer/

Microsoft Learn: hxxps://learn[.]microsoft[.]com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-devicefileevents-table

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Classification: Hunting | Confidence: Medium | No customer data | Defanging verified | Eight A4 pages | Controlled black/white/violet/magenta/lime master adaptation